



The People of the Pacific and Australia

THE FIRST INHABITANTS of this area were the Aborigines and Torres Strait Islanders of Australia, Tongans, Tahitians, Samoans, Micronesians, Melanesians, and the Polynesians—such as the New Zealand Maori. They are thought to have originated from Southeast Asia, arriving as far back as 40,000 years ago.

A fifth of Australia's population lives in Sydney.

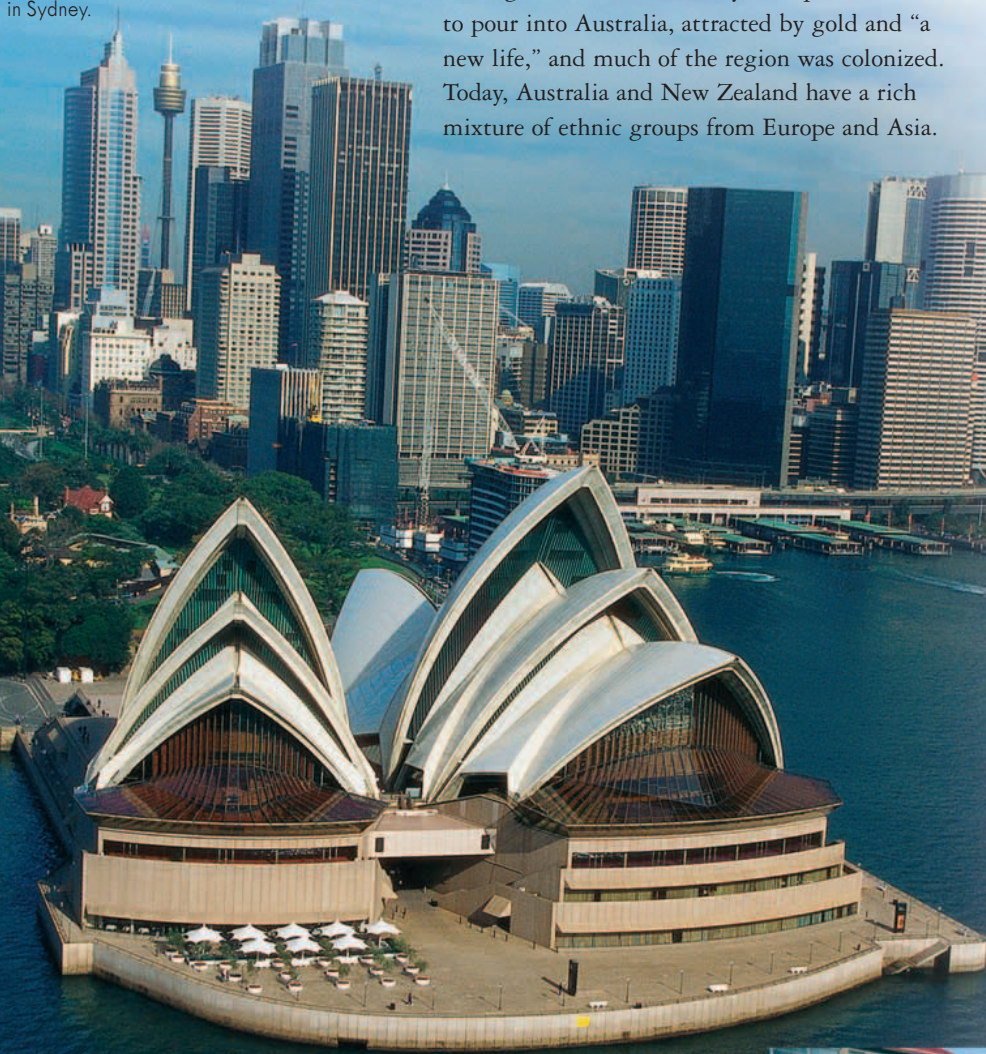
COLONIZATION

During the late 18th century, Europeans started to pour into Australia, attracted by gold and “a new life,” and much of the region was colonized. Today, Australia and New Zealand have a rich mixture of ethnic groups from Europe and Asia.



CITY LIFE

The amount of people in Oceania is very low. Australia is one of the least densely populated areas on Earth. Eighty percent of Australia's population live within 25 miles (40 km) of the coast, most in cities such as Melbourne, and Sydney.



SPORT

One of the popular sports in Oceanic culture is rugby. The Australian and New Zealand—“All Blacks”—teams have some of the world's best players. The Pacific Islands, such as Fiji and Samoa, also have international teams.



FARMING

Australia and New Zealand both rely on their resources for income, such as sheep and cattle farming, and mining.

